

Livewire: Wire Together, Make Your Circuit Live

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A review on *malavida.com* terms Livewire as “a sophisticated electronic circuit board design and simulation software.” Stephen Smith, a user from the UK says, “I am currently using Livewire during my studies for Higher National Certificate (electronics) and I find that it stands head and shoulders above the rest in user friendliness.”

And here is what another user, Richard, from Bramhall High School, UK, has to say, “What is the verdict? As you may have gathered from reading this, I am sold. I am still going to have to teach $V = I \times R$ and the meaning of Schmitt, but here is a set of tools that has already made an impact on the quality of my teaching and the ease of learning in the classroom. Buy it!”

The above comments must have raised the curiosity of everyone reading this article, I am sure. What is Livewire? Why is it so popular? Where can it be used? How to get the best out of it?

Have a look at Livewire

To put it in simple terms, Livewire is an electronic circuit board editor. Specifically designed to aid electrical and electronics engineers, the tool lets you connect switches, transistors, diodes, integrated circuits and hundreds of other components together, and investigate the behaviour of a circuit. No loose connections, no faulty components! You are the detective, and the circuit is your

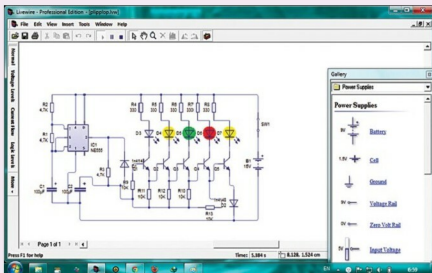


Fig. 1: Creating with Livewire (Image courtesy: <https://fajar-el-ridkic.blogspot.com>)

Make sure your computer is equipped with these bare minimum before you get on to Livewire:

- IBM-compatible PC with an x86 processor
- Microsoft Windows 95, 98, ME, NT 4.0 (with SP6), XP, Vista, 7 or later operating system
- 64MB of RAM (128MB memory recommended; the requirement is excluding that of the operating system)
- 10MB of available hard disk space
- Video graphics array or higher-resolution monitor
- Microsoft mouse or compatible pointing device

case. But let currents spike beyond permissible levels and you are on your own!

A user interface designed with care. What makes this attractive to newcomers is the simple user interface. You can build a circuit in no time as the components are readily available and the inbuilt wiring tool is designed to be intelligent. Select your components and add these to the drawing board, connect and move these as you want—the tool

preserves all connections and even re-routes wiring, if required.

Put your circuit to action by simulating

Similar to a video, the circuit jumps into action when you hit the start button. The view is basically one of a well-constructed animation, with the difference being that the control is in your hands. You can turn on switches or adjust components by using the mouse,